

Northwind Analytics Employee Handbook

Introduction

This handbook describes the employment policies of Northwind Analytics for all permanent employees. It applies to every office and to employees working remotely. Where local law conflicts with this handbook, local law prevails.

The handbook is maintained by the People Operations team and is reviewed every twelve months. The current revision is HB-7.2, effective 1 January 2025.

Working Hours

The standard working week is 40 hours, normally worked between Monday and Friday. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in the employee's local time zone, during which employees are expected to be reachable.

Employees may shift their start time between 07:00 and 10:00 with the agreement of their line manager. Overtime is not expected; where it occurs, time off in lieu is granted at a one to one ratio and must be taken within 60 days.

Annual Leave

Employees are entitled to 22 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays observed in their country of employment.

Annual leave accrues monthly at a rate of 1.83 days per completed month of service. Employees joining mid-year receive a pro-rated entitlement.

A maximum of 5 unused annual leave days may be carried over into the following calendar year. Carried-over days expire on 31 March and are not paid out.

Requests for more than three consecutive days of leave must be submitted at least 10 working days in advance. Line managers must approve or decline a leave request within 5 working days of submission.

Sick Leave

Employees receive 10 paid sick days per calendar year. Unused sick days do not carry over and are not paid out on termination.

Employees must notify their line manager before 09:30 on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required from the fourth consecutive day of absence.

Absence beyond 10 days in a calendar year is handled under the long-term absence procedure, which is managed by People Operations together with the employee.

Parental Leave

The primary caregiver is entitled to 16 weeks of parental leave at full pay. The secondary caregiver is entitled to 4 weeks at full pay.

Parental leave must start within 12 months of the birth or adoption of the child and may be taken in up to three separate blocks with manager agreement.

Employees returning from parental leave may request a reduced schedule of 80 percent for up to six months at 80 percent of salary.

Remote Work

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week by default. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a Vice President and are reviewed annually.

A home office stipend of 400 US dollars is available every two years and covers desk, chair, monitor and lighting equipment. The stipend does not cover internet subscriptions or coworking memberships.

Employees working from a country other than their country of employment for more than 30 days in a rolling twelve month period must obtain approval from People Operations because of tax and immigration exposure.

Expenses and Travel

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the date the expense was incurred. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed.

The meal per diem is 65 US dollars for domestic travel and 95 US dollars for international travel. Receipts are not required for per diem claims.

Flights under 6 hours must be booked in economy class. Business class may be booked for flights longer than 8 hours with prior manager approval.

Hotel spending is capped at 220 US dollars per night for domestic travel and 300 US dollars per night for international travel, excluding local taxes.

Performance and Promotion

Performance reviews take place twice per year, in April and in October. Reviews use a five point rating scale where 3 means fully meets expectations.

Promotion decisions are made only in the October cycle. A promotion case requires a written submission from the line manager and two peer references.

Employees rated 1 are placed on a structured 60 day performance improvement plan with fortnightly checkpoints.

Referrals

Employees receive a referral bonus of 1500 US dollars when a referred candidate is hired and completes 6 months of continuous service. There is no limit on the number of referrals an employee may make.

Probation and Notice

New employees serve a probation period of 3 months, which may be extended once by up to 3 additional months.

The notice period is 4 weeks during the first year of service, 6 weeks from the second year, and 8 weeks after two completed years of service.

On termination, accrued and unused annual leave from the current calendar year is paid out. Carried-over days from a previous year are not paid out.

Learning and Development

Every employee has an annual learning budget of 2000 US dollars. The budget covers courses, books, conference tickets and professional memberships. It does not roll over into the next year.

Employees may take up to 5 paid learning days per calendar year. Learning days are requested in the same system as annual leave and are approved by the line manager.

Professional certification fees are reimbursed in full on a first successful attempt. Repeat attempts are reimbursed at 50 percent.

Equipment and IT Support

Company laptops are refreshed every 3 years. Employees may keep their previous laptop only after it has been wiped and formally transferred by the IT team.

Employees who take part in an on-call rotation receive a mobile phone allowance of 40 US dollars per month.

Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to the IT service desk within 24 hours so that the device can be remotely wiped.

Business Conduct

Employees may not accept a gift from a supplier or customer with a value above 75 US dollars. Gifts above this value must be declined or surrendered to People Operations.

Any potential conflict of interest must be disclosed in writing within 14 days of the employee becoming aware of it.

Northwind Analytics prohibits facilitation payments of any kind, in any jurisdiction, without exception.

Grievance Procedure

An employee should first raise a concern informally with their line manager. If that is not appropriate, the concern may be raised with People Operations directly.

A formal written grievance receives a response within 10 working days. The employee may appeal the outcome within 5 working days of receiving it.

An employee may be accompanied by a colleague at any formal grievance meeting.